

Top 10 Open Source Tools for Linux Systems Administrators

Linux systems administrators need a number of tools to keep their systems well-oiled and running smoothly at peak efficiency levels. Here is a set of ten tools which will help them, whether they are newbies or veterans getting a refresher course.



A systems administrator's job is complex, covering responsibilities that range from managing systems to intrusion detection. Thankfully, the world of open source software provides a comprehensive set of tools to simplify admin tasks. The following list of ten key open source tools covers all the bases.

1. Cockpit

Cockpit is software developed by Red Hat that provides an interactive browser based Linux administration interface. Its graphical interface allows beginner system administrators to perform common sysadmin tasks without the requisite skills on the command line. In addition to making systems easier to manage for novice administrators, Cockpit also makes systems configuration and performance data accessible to them, even if they

do not know command line tools. It is available via the Cockpit package in the Red Hat Linux 7 extras repository. You can install Cockpit using the following command:

```
# yum -y install cockpit.-
```

Once installed on a system, Cockpit must be started before it can be accessed across the network, as shown below. Cockpit can be accessed remotely via HTTPS using a Web browser and by connecting to TCP Port 9090. This port must be opened on the system firewall for Cockpit to be accessed remotely. It is defined as the *Cockpit* for *firewalls*.

```
# systemctl start cockpit
# firewall-cmd --add-service=cockpit --permanent
# firewall-cmd --reload
```